



Thinnest speakers

Richard Haberkern – a tinkerer, is trying to make paper thin speakers. You can back him on his kickstarter : <http://dgit.in/PaperSpeakers>



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The Largest Cosmic Structures

We imagine the Universe to be vast open spaces of vacuum filled with planets, stars and other interstellar objects. Each of these appears to be one single structure surrounded



by many others. But in astronomical terms we have quantified them as systems, galaxies and nebulae based on how they congregate with respect to their gravitational entanglements.

In this regard cosmic structures can vary greatly in size and scope. The Hercules–Corona Borealis Great Wall structure was found in November 2013 to be the largest known cosmic structure ever discovered. It was detected by mapping the location of gamma radiation bursts which were caused by exploding stars within it. By measuring these bursts researchers were able to estimate the size and expanse of the superstructure. Astronomers are currently making sense of this Great Wall, which is 10 billion light years across.

The Strongest Natural Substance

Limpets are snail like creatures that you wouldn't imagine having teeth. They resemble clams and are found by the shore side. But surprisingly they possess the strongest naturally



occurring substance known in their teeth. This fact was discovered by Asa Barber and her research team at the University of Portsmouth when they inspected limpet teeth at the atomic level. Until

this discovery the strongest naturally occurring substance was thought to be the silk of a spider but no more. In nature, limpets use their teeth to grab onto rocky surfaces and chisel out the algae in the rocks for food. The unique material engineering aspect of this discovery is that irrespective of size, the strength of limpet teeth remains constant. Scientists and engineers are trying to figure out a way to mimic their structure for use in civil, marine, automotive and electronic engineering projects.

The Longest Standing Math Problem

Until 1995 the longest standing unsolved math problem was Fermat's Last Theorem. But after 365 years of being a puzzle to generations of mathematicians it was finally solved by Andrew



Wiles. Replacing it was the ever notorious Goldbach's Conjecture which was proposed by Christian Goldbach in 1742 and has since remained a mystery. The Goldbach Conjecture is not a complicated problem to state, it simply posits that every positive even numbered integer greater than 3 is the

sum total of two prime numbers. For example, the positive even number integer 8 is a sum total of two primes 3 and 5. Sounds simple enough, right? However, there has been no conclusive proof that this is a constant rule. Finding methods to prove or disprove this conjecture haven't been created in the last 273 years. Although, by means of heuristic logic it is highly likely that the conjecture is true, no mathematician has as of yet proved it conclusively.

The Most Powerful Magnet in Nature

The cosmos is littered with the permutation and combination of nature. In the near chaotic interactions of space, where matter and time combine to deliver remarkable results,



we find the oddest of objects. When it comes to nature's most powerful magnet, we have to look no farther than our own galaxy for collapsed neutron stars called magne-

tars. Two competing neutron stars, of the soft gamma repeater variety, called SGR 1806-20 and SGR 0418 claim the title of the most powerful magnets ever discovered. Both of these rotating neutron stars possess a magnetic force capable of slowing down a Rajdhani express train as far away as the Moon. The SGR 1806-20 is only 50,000 light years from Earth, while SGR 0418 is closer at about 6,500 light years away. The former was discovered in 1979, while the latter was revealed to us as a magnetar in 2013, four years after its 2009 discovery. Perhaps the most attractive pair of lights in the sky. Sorry, couldn't help it. 